



It becomes difficult for enterprises to manage infrastructure because of the rate and pace of change in technology and the skills needed to operate on-premise HPC. So, instead of buying technology, they are looking to use it as a cloud service

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HPCaaS is growing in India, but slightly slower than the rest of the world

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It is not the technology that differentiates HPC and HPCaaS, but the way an organisation uses and funds it

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ter & Cloud Technologies is offering 100,000 free core hours of accessing HPCaaS for educational and technical institutes. “More than 10 prestigious institutes are running multiple complex job runs on the cluster consuming more than 50,000 to 70,000 core hours each,” says Rajesh Dangi, Chief Digital Officer, NxtGen Data-center & Cloud Technologies, adding that most of these institutes are already in advanced discussions for long-term contracts with the company.

The Cost Benefit

Instead of investing millions, HPCaaS can be accessed for a starting price of as low as ₹11,000 per month, which could run into a few lakhs depending on the configuration and workload. Yotta’s most basic Eco plan starts at ₹11,000 with unlimited data transfer and host anti-virus. And its most high-end offering—Baremetal Premium—is available for ₹1.74 lakh per month (see *The Pricing* for details). The company says these plans are capable of handling different kinds of workloads. The Eco configuration is targeted at students and academics who use legacy compute (old technology, computer system or application, related to an older or outdated computer system). And premium plans are designed for industrial and enterprise use, for example, manufacturing industries using AI for production, or financial services companies working on analysis of big data and real-time fraud detection, among others.

A big concern that HPCaaS addresses is security, as it typically follows the same checks and balances as any other application being served through the cloud. Using a consumption model, especially through external providers, is a two-way street. “Both the user and the vendor have a significant role to play in securing the cluster. Securing data and IP become key areas that need special attention, and encrypting the data while at rest and in flight play a key role in securing the same,” explains Manish Gupta, Senior Director and General Manager, Infrastructure Solutions Group, Dell Technologies, India. HPCaaS providers follow a strict security and protection protocol and, as a result, many companies who started with HPC on-premises, tend to supplement their workload with HPCaaS.

Which brings us back to TVS Motor. The company has moved 25 per cent of its HPC workload to HPCaaS, and as the existing HPC cluster reaches the end of its life, the newer clusters will be taken on HPCaaS. Given that TVS has had a history of using HPC on-premise, you would be forgiven for thinking that TVS would be more capable of leveraging HPCaaS. Does that mean others who have not used HPC before, can’t use HPCaaS? Just the opposite holds true. That’s the beauty of the cloud-based approach. **BT**